

CONCEPT NOTE

FIYMA Program Planning Workshop

29 June to 3 July 2026

Venue: To be confirmed

1.0 Background and context

The Financial Inclusion for Youths and MSMEs in Agriculture (FIYMA) program is a collaborative initiative between Micro Enterprises Support Programme Trust (MESPT) and consortium partners, East Africa Market Development Associates (EAMDA), National Cooperative Business Association-Cooperative League of the USA (NCBA-CLUSA) and Women's Empowerment Link (WEL).

The program aims to address the challenges faced by youth-owned Micro, Small, and Medium Agribusiness Enterprises (MSMEs) in accessing flexible, patient, and affordable finance and therefore enabling business growth and profitability resulting in poverty alleviation for financially disadvantaged young people. Ultimately the programme target is to have at least 250,000 financially disadvantaged youth in work by working with 2000 SMEs and 100,000 financially disadvantaged young people in 20,000 groups. 70% of participants is expected to be young women, 7.5% people living with disabilities and 2.5% refugees who have higher rates of poverty.

This will be achieved through delivery the following 4 programme outcomes:

- Increased access to affordable credit for MSMEs owned and operated by young, financially disadvantaged entrepreneurs in the agricultural sector through disbursement of USD 17Million;
- 100,000 young financially disadvantaged entrepreneurs, of whom approximately 70% are women, accessing finance and business development services to grow their MSMEs resulting in increased incomes;
- 150,000 direct and indirect work opportunities created and/or improved for financially disadvantaged young people;
- At least 20,000 groups of young financially disadvantaged entrepreneurs will be operating with increased business sophistication and, in some cases, registered as new SACCOs to access further financing.

As part of the ongoing inception period various technical working group have been formed to facilitate development of programme implementation strategies, roadmaps, guidelines, MEAL and communication plans as well as requisite tools and reporting structures. Whereas these critical documents are now in place and in use, there is need to build a common understanding amongst the programme staff majority of whom recently joined the team hence didn't participate in the design of the same. Therefore, this workshop will enable each team members learn on the programme expectations, their roles and responsibilities in delivering the programme results as well as prioritised actions for inception phase and year 1 deliverables.

2.0 Objectives of the workshop

In overall, this workshop is aimed at bringing together the FIYMA program team members from all consortium partners to build shared understanding and strategic alignment on expected programme results, impact pathways of change, data and reporting requirements aligned with the Foundation shared measures framework, implementation strategies/ approaches as well development of the 5year programme workplan.

3.0 Expected outcomes

- Validated MEAL plan
- Aligned program implementation strategies/ approaches with pathways of change
- 5 years programme workplan
- Clarity on partners roles and responsibilities

4.0 Structure and approach

The workshop will deploy practical, participatory and collaborative methods in validation of MEAL plan, Pathways of change, data and reporting requirements as well as refinements of the implementation strategies/ approaches and development of 5-year workplan

5.0 Target participants

Aligned with the available budget, the proposed participants are as follows;

Partner	Proposed participants	Pax
MESPT	• CEO (1)-attend first day for opening and keynote address • Core program team: (Program Director (1), Credit Managers(3), Credit Officers (4), Communications (2), MEAL staff (2), Finance (2), Capacity Building Co-Ordinator(1), Programme Assistant (1) GSYI Advisor (1), ICT (1),	18
EAMDA	• Managing Partner(1) -attend first day for opening and keynote address • Program Manager (1), Technical Leads (2), MEAL Staff (3), Finance (2), Communications (1), Safeguarding & Inclusion (1), Regional Coordinators (7).	18
WEL	• Executive Director (1)-attend first day for opening and keynote address • Technical Lead (1), Program Manager (1), Gender and Safeguarding(1), MEAL (1), Finance (1), Communications (1), Regional Coordinators (7)	14
NCBA-CLUSA	• Country Director (1)- attend first day for opening and keynote address: • • Programme manager (1), MEAL Lead (1) , Finance (2), Regional Coordinators (6)	11
Total Pax		61

6. Proposed Agenda & Programme

Date/Time	Activity	Lead
29.06.2026	Participant arrival and check in	ALL
DAY 1: 30th June 2026		
8:00- 8:10	Welcoming & Introductions	Programme Director
8:10-8:20	Opening Remarks	• CEO-MESPT • Managing Partner EAMDA • Executive Director WEL • Country Director- NCBA-CLUSA
8:20-9:00	FIYMA Program Overview, Objectives and expected deliverables	Programme Director
9:00-10:30	Young women Centric design/ approach	Safeguarding & Inclusion Lead-WEL
10:30-11:00	TEA BREAK	ALL
11:00-13:00	Overview of FIYMA Theory of Change	MEAL Manager-MESPT
	Overview of FIYMA Results Framework, indicators & core program targets aligned with Mastercard Foundation-shared measures 2.0 framework	
13:00-14:00	LUNCH BREAK	ALL
14:00-17:00	Alignment of Program implementation strategies: • Component 1: Access to finance • Component2: Entrepreneurship Skills Building and Business Development Services: • Component 3a: Increase Capacity of SACCOs & Market Actors SMEs on GEDSI and safeguarding Initiatives • Component 3b: Increase Capacity of Youth Groups plus Youth cooperatives and SACCOs. <i>[sessions include tea break and continuation]</i>	Program Director • Credit Manager: MESPT • Program Manager: EAMDA • Program Lead: WEL • Program Lead: NCBA-CLUSA
DAY 2: 1st July 2026		
8:00-8:15	Recap of day 1	To be assigned
8:15-9:15	Safeguarding, requirements, commitments and implementation approaches	Safeguarding & Inclusion Leads: MESPT and WEL
9:15-10:30	Presentation on GEDSI objectives, requirements, Guidelines and implementation approaches (<i>Young woman centric design and implementation across interventions</i>)	Safeguarding & Inclusion Lead: MESPT and WEL
10:30-11:00	TEA BREAK	ALL
11:20-11:20	Financial Management & Reporting Guidelines	Head of Finance-MESPT

12:20-13:20	Program risk management frameworks	Head of Finance-MESPT
13:20-14:00	LUNCH BREAK	ALL
14:00-15:30	Unpacking the program Pathways of change and strategic actions linked to program outcomes/ impact delivery	Programme Managers-Partner Organizations
15:30-17:00	Group Presentation plus plenary discussions	MEAL Manager-MESPT
DAY 3: 2nd July 2026		
8:00-8:15	Recap of Day 2	To be assigned
8:15-11:00	Development of 5-year Workplan & Budget Group Task-partner level led by respective Program Managers)	- Programme Director - MEAL Leads - Head of Finance-MESPT
11:00-11:20	TEA BREAK	ALL
11:20-13:00	Development of 5-year program workplans + Budget estimates cont'd. (<i>Group Work at partner organization level lead by Programme Managers for each partner organization.</i>)	- Programme Director - MEAL Leads - Head of Finance-MESPT
12:30-13:00	LUNCH BREAK	ALL
14:00-17:00	Development of 5-year program workplans + Budget estimates. (<i>Group Work at partner organization level lead by Programme Managers for each partner organization.</i>)	- Programme Director - MEAL Leads
DAY 4 : 3rd July 2026		
8:00-8:15	Recap of day 3	To be assigned
8:15-9:30	Présentation on brand guidelines, communication protocols, and key communication messagings	COMS Leads-MESPT and EAMDA
9:30-10:00	Programme reporting requirements plus internal/ external schedules	MEAL Manager-MESPT
10:00-10:30	TEA BREAK	ALL
10:00-14:00	Presentations-Draft 5-Year workplans and Budget by partner - MESPT- 1HR - EADMA - WEL - NCBA- CLUSA	Credit Manager- MESPT Programme Manager- EADMA Programme Manager- WEL Programme Manager-NCBA CLUSA
14:00-14:45	LUNCH BREAK	ALL
14:45-16:30	- Completion and submission of pending deliverables. - Key Next Steps+ Priorities. - Workshop closing Remarks	Programme Director Consortium Program Leads
	Closing and departure for Nairobi-based team.	All